

Church History





About the Course

Students read about important events and influential people from Church History using biographies and narrative-driven overviews of the time period. In this course, students delve into the 19th century and learn the stories of a variety of Christians.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8, Bible: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Can be combined with Grades 5-6.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-9	Church History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	Spurgeon: A Biography Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Church History: Grades 7-9



Spurgeon: A Biography



Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward



An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Church History: Grades 7-9

∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Church History: Grades 7-9

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

William Wilberforce

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward,

→ INTRO

1. This year we are learning about people who lived during the 19th century (1800-1900). We will read how these Christians lived out Jesus' commands. When Jesus was asked what the greatest command was, he replied, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the great and first commandment. And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself." (Matthew 22:37-39)

2. Today you will read about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. Parliament consisted of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the commerce and national security of Great Britain.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Painting of William Wilberforce

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-100 (whole chapter)

• Wilberforce had considered withdrawing from public life for the sake of his faith. However, his pastor Joh Newton advised him, "It is hoped and believed that the Lord has raised you up for the good of his church and for the good of the nation." What do you think about that advice?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Wilberforce 1759-1833
Slave Trade was abolished in England 1833

DEFINITIONS

diminutive(p.93)-small size

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Fact Files: The Beacons of Freedom and Justice

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

Give a brief account of what you remember about William Wilberforce.

→ INTRO

In this section "The Beacons of Freedom and Justice" you will be introduced to four historical figures who were motivated by their Christian faith to help others find freedom and justice. The first person lived in the 1700's so that is the century before the time period we are studying this year.

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.101-102 "Freedom is a word" - "should be applauded."

2. Watch this video that tells about Oglethorpe's role in the founding of Georgia and then takes us up to the 19th century.

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.102-104 "Another Englishman who" - "Thee Are Spoken."

2. p.104-107 "While men like" - "fight for themselves."

3. Read this article to learn more Harriet Tubman.

∞ Article Link: Black Moses

• IMPORTANT DATES

Oglethorpe founds the colony of Georgia
John Newton pens Amazing Grace
Frederick Douglas
Harriet Tubman

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Learn more about John Newton, the author of Amazing Grace
∞ **Article Link:** The Story of John Newton
∞ **Video Link:** Newton's Grace: The True Story of Amazing Grace

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Emilie Mallet

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What do you remember about our last reading?

→ INTRO

Today you will read about a French lady from the 1800s who may be unknown to you but has an interesting story of love and service those in need. She could have just enjoyed her upper-class lifestyle but wanted to show the love of Christ to others.

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Emilie Mallet

2. The Pantheon in Paris (not to be confused with the Pantheon in Rome) is mentioned in this chapter. It is a mausoleum or monument that houses the remains of distinguished French citizens,

∞ Image Link: Parthenon in Paris

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.109-117

2. Read these excerpts from the biography **A Christian woman; being the life of Mme. Jules Mallet, translated by Mrs. H.N. Goodhart. Most of it are journal entries from Emilie about the circumstances in Paris.**

∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from biography, A Christian Woman

• What did you learn about Emilie from her journal entries?

• DEFINITIONS

cholera: (p.109) disease that is caused by bacteria through water or food that has been tainted. Cholera can cause serious diarrhea and dehydration and can be fatal.

aristocracy: (p.111) upper class usually made up of a hereditary nobility

• IMPORTANT DATES

Emilie Mallet begins her charity work for young children and prisoners

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) QR

Term 1

→ VIEW

Have you seen Toile de Jouy fabric before? It is actually French for 'cloth from Jouy. It was produced by Emilie's father and can still be found today on decorative fabrics and wallpaper.

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

Sojourner Truth

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

Note: We are skipping the chapter on Charles Spurgeon since we are reading a whole book about him starting in Term 2.

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.

→ VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Sojourner Truth

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.

→ VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

WEEK 6

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Robert Moffat

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.

→ VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

WEEK 7

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Hudson Taylor

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.

→ VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

WEEK 8

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Fact Files:

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.

→ VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

WEEK 9

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

• IMPORTANT DATES

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1		
	→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. → VIEW	
WEEK 10	30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. → VIEW	• IMPORTANT DATES
WEEK 11	30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward → INTRO → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p. → VIEW	
WEEK 12	30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Renewal: The Church Expands Outward	

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13

The Boy and the Books

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, book of centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time in Church History?

→ INTRO

The next book we will be reading in Church History is a biography about Charles H. Spurgeon. Born in 1834, Spurgeon was a pastor and author who lived a life of faithful ministry. His devotional writings are still read by many today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 1 p.3-12

Optional: "Conditions in England During Spurgeon's Time" p.xv-xvii

→ NOTE *****WHAT IS THE CORRECT PROMPT*****

Enter Spurgeon's birthdate into your book of centuries.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Charles H. Spurgeon born June 19, 1834

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14

Conversion & Joy in Serving

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-27

•On p.21 the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what will be coming in the book: "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." How do you think having this goal or idea in mind helped Spurgeon in his ministry? As we continue reading, note in what ways he stays consistent with this important point in his ministry.

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15

The Boy Preacher

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-29; 31-40

•The author divides up the book into four main parts, with today's reading closing out the first part of the book. What are three main events from these early years of Spurgeon's life that stood out to you that seem to be preparing him for a life of ministry?

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16

Called to Be a Pastor

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, book of centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-53

→ VIEW

Image Resource: Spurgeon: A Biography - images located after p.87

View the first four pages of pictures in your book (located after p.87). Look at the image of Spurgeon at the age of 20 (around the time of being called as a pastor). Do you think those who put him down for his young age had a point? Why or why not?

• IMPORTANT DATES

April 1854 - Begins pastordship in London at the age of 19

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17

Charles and Susannah

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography; book of centuries

NOTE: We will skip chapter 7 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.55-62

77-81 "For three years"- "salvation of souls."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Jan. 8, 1856 - Charles and Susannah Married

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

Term 2

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Charles and Susannah and the Crystal Palace
View the images at the link to see Charles and Susannah at a young age and the Crystal Palace in London.

WEEK 6

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18

The Church Grows

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Today's reading is a bit shorter. Use any extra time to catch up on reading or to read the article at the link.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Spurgeon placed importance on prayer and on the people who were attending his church. Their conversion was a deep desire of his heart. The church he led put into place some ways of following up with those who professed salvation and who wanted to be members. As you read, consider how these ideas would work in a modern church today. Would any of the ideas be helpful? Would any not work in a modern church? Why or why not?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.81-87 "His was a"-great Metropolitan Temple."

•Do you think any of the ideas the church implemented to follow up with those who wanted to be members were helpful? Would any of those ideas work in a modern church? Why or why not?

→ OPTIONAL: READ THE LINKED ARTICLE CONTAINING A VISITOR'S EXPERIENCE HEARING SPURGEON PREACH.

∞ Article Link: What It Was Like to Hear Charles Spurgeon Preach

→ VIEW

Take some time to look at the rest of the images included in the book (located after p.87). What do you notice?

WEEK 7

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19

The Metropolitan Tabernacle

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography; book of centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The Metropolitan Tabernacle would be the church Spurgeon would spend the rest of his days as a preacher. In today's reading, he also will speak to a record-setting crowd of 23,654 at The Crystal Palace, the place he and Susannah had spent so much time. Imagine speaking - with just your voice! - to that large of a crowd!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.91-99

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Metropolitan Tabernacle

The link shows the Metropolitan Tabernacle in more recent times. The Tabernacle is still active as a church to this day, although it has had to be rebuilt twice, once due to a fire and then after a bombing during World War II. It has a slightly different design to its front after its latest rebuild.

• IMPORTANT DATES

March 31, 1861 - First Sunday Service at the Metropolitan Tabernacle

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Spurgeon's Fast Day Sermon

Read the sermon Spurgeon preached to the record-setting crowd at The Crystal Palace.

WEEK 8

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20

The Pastors' College

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The next couple of chapters start to show the growth of Spurgeon's ministry outside of his pastorate. First, a college is started to train young pastors.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.101-109

WEEK 9

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21

New Ways of Reaching the Community

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Parts of this chapter will be skipped for the sake of time.

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-113 "In 1865 Spurgeon"- "build God's work."

p.115-122 "But though Spurgeon"- "days on earth."

•The church began reaching out into the community using the publishing of a magazine, printing of sermons, and building new churches. In what ways is the message of the gospel spread by the church you attend? Are any of those ways similar to what the Metropolitan Tabernacle used? In what new (modern) ways does your church use to reach the surrounding community?

WEEK 10

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22

Widows & Orphans

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 p.125-130

p.133-137 "From the late"- "of the gout."

James 1:27- "Religion that is pure and undefiled before God the Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained from the world."

•Based on today's reading and the verse above, do you agree or disagree with the author's statement that "The orphanage was a lasting demonstration of the fact that Spurgeon's faith was not mere theory but that it produced good works" (p.130)? Why or why not?

WEEK 11

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23

Mrs. Spurgeon

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Charles Spurgeon's wife Susannah was a big part of his ministry and today's chapter brings her work into the picture. Mrs. Spurgeon suffered from a medical illness that kept her from traveling or even attending church services for much of her adult life. However, today's reading will show how God brought together her unique abilities to minister to others and enabled her to have an impact on many.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-150 "Of this attack"- "and comfort others."

→ VIEW

 Image Link: Susie Spurgeon

WEEK 12

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Spurgeon: A Biography

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3

WEEK 1

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25 *The Lively Church*

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.153-161

WEEK 2

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26 *Books*

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **INTRO**

In today's reading, Spurgeon's library of 12,000 books is mentioned. Spurgeon felt it was imperative that those who were teaching the Bible be learned and readers of books. In fact, he gave two pieces of advice about books to students: "1. Buy a few, high-quality books; 2. "Master those books you have." "Read them thoroughly," he wrote. "Bathe in them until they saturate you. Read and re-read them, masticate them, and digest them. Let them go into your very self. Peruse a good book several times, and make notes and analyses of it. A student will find that his mental constitution is more affected by one book thoroughly mastered than by twenty books which he has merely skimmed, lapping at them, as the classic proverb puts it 'As the dogs drink of Nilus.'"

He also is quoted as having said, "Visit many good books, but live in the Bible." As time allows, view the extra helping link to see a tour of a library that now holds half of his collection of books, including a commentary on Psalms from 1476.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.16 p.163-175

EXTRA HELPING

View the video at the link to see the library where 6,000 of Spurgeon's books are kept. You'll also see artifacts from Spurgeon's life, including a short recording of his voice.

WEEK 3

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27 *Spurgeon's Character*

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.17 p.177-188

WEEK 4

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28 *Spurgeon As An Author*

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.18 p.191-201

∞ Link: Morning and Evening Devotional

Optional: Read the linked passage from Spurgeon's Morning and Evening Devotional book.

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link: The Sword & The Trowel magazine

View the link to see the magazine published by Spurgeon, "The Sword & The Trowel."

WEEK 5

30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29 *Controversy*

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **INTRO**

There are two parts to your reading today. First, read the assigned pages in the biography of Spurgeon that discuss a controversy that came up. There was a movement called Higher Criticism that moved through churches in the mid-1800s. This movement caused people to have a lower view of the Bible, which Spurgeon was highly motivated to argue against. After reading the pages in the book, read the linked sermon which Spurgeon spoke during this time. You may split the sermon reading between this week and next week to fit the time allotted.

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.19 p.205-209 "The Metropolitan Tabernacle"-"their firm opposition." ∞ Link: "Poverty and Riches" Sermon by Spurgeon If needed, the sermon may be divided between this week and next week's lesson time.	
WEEK 6  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30 <i>Glory Dwelleth in Immanuel's Land</i>  Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography; book of centuries NOTE: A few pages are skipped at the beginning of the chapter for time's sake. Assigned pages are listed below. → RECAP What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time? → INTRO Toward the end of his life, Spurgeon experienced much physical pain and sickness. However, he held tight to his faith and looked forward to being with his Savior. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.224-233 "He found relief"-"is far better." ∞ Link: Poverty and Riches Sermon by Spurgeon Complete your reading of the sermon if needed. •In the first lesson on the biography of Spurgeon, we noted the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what Spurgeon strived to keep in mind when telling others about the gospel (p.21): "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." Now that you have read more on Spurgeon, do you think he was able to remain faithful to this goal or aim of his ministry? How?	• IMPORTANT DATES January 31, 1892 - Charles H. Spurgeon Dies
WEEK 7  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31  Materials: → RECAP What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time? → INTRO ***NOTE FOR SHANNON** -There is an end chapter that covers Spurgeon's funeral which could be skipped. So I'm leaving this lesson open to either your book or Spurgeon - we can make that decision when you know if you want 4 or 5 lessons to cover the final book?**** → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS → VIEW	
WEEK 8  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32 <i>An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words</i>	
WEEK 9  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33 <i>An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words</i>	
WEEK 10  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34 <i>An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words</i>	
WEEK 11  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35 <i>An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words</i>	
WEEK 12  30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from:	